

**DRY LEAVES**

Some Darjeeling dry leaves have a slight green color, and may be whole or broken.

**LIQUOR**

This golden liquor of Darjeeling tastes of apple and spice, and has an aroma reminiscent of muscatel grapes.

**WET LEAVES**

While infused Darjeeling leaves appear brown and green, the wet leaves of other black teas may be mahogany, walnut, or even golden in color.

BLACK TEA

Black tea is the most well-known tea in the western world. Familiarity with black tea usually begins with tea-bag tea and famous blends, such as English Breakfast. This familiarity might lead us to expect the same character from all black teas, but there are many varieties with complex flavors and characteristics.

Black tea is fully oxidized, its polyphenols having converted to thearubigins (color) and theaflavonoids (flavor). Heftier varieties, such as Assam, can be complemented with milk and/or sugar, but it is better to taste a delicate tea, such as a first flush Darjeeling, in its natural state, before deciding to add anything.

Historically, most premium black tea is produced in India or Sri Lanka, but owing to its growing popularity among the Chinese, black tea production is set to increase in that region.

PREPARATION GUIDELINES

Tea shown here: First flush Darjeeling, from Darjeeling, India

Measure: 2 tsp for $\frac{3}{4}$ cup water

Water Temperature: 210°F (100°C)

Infusion: Steep for 2 minutes. Some whole-leaf black teas, such as Darjeeling or Chinese black teas, may be infused a second time. For these, add 1–2 minutes to the infusion time.